

N8N Automations

Brief

Portfolio explainer document
Prepared for Salman Adnan

Generated 2026-07-07

What this document is. A concise, accurate overview of the `n8n-automations/` folder: 59 workflow-automation builds made in n8n for Digitalise Agency. For the exhaustive version with eight fully diagrammed worked examples, see `deep-dive.pdf` in the same folder. Every fact below is drawn from the top-level `README.md`, `N8N_WORKFLOW_PROPOSALS.md`, and a close reading of 14 individual automation READMEs across every category in the collection.

Contents

1	What n8n is, briefly	1
2	The collection at a glance	2
3	Three worked examples	2
3.1	Google Maps to Email Scraper	2
3.2	Ultimate Personal Assistant System	2
3.3	WhatsApp AI Sales Lead System	3
4	Curation methodology, at a summary level	3
5	Recurring, honestly-documented defects	4
6	What remains blocked, and why	4

1 What n8n is, briefly

n8n is a **visual workflow automation tool**: instead of a script, you build an automation as a **node graph** on a canvas — boxes (**nodes**) doing one job each, connected by lines showing which node's output feeds which node's input. It is still engineering work: triggers, API calls, LLM steps, and data transforms chained into a working system, expressed as a diagram instead of text, with the same kinds of bugs a sloppy script would have.

Trigger starts a workflow (a schedule, a webhook, a form, a Telegram message). **Webhook** is a URL another system can call to start a workflow instantly. **Connection** is the line between two nodes; special AI-only connection kinds attach a model, memory, or tool to an agent, separately from the plain connection that actually starts a node running. **Sub-workflow / orchestrator** means one workflow calls another whole workflow as a single step, the way a program calls a function. **AI agent node** wraps an LLM in a loop with a set of callable tools, deciding at run time which to call. **RAG (retrieval-augmented generation)** means chunking real documents, embedding them into a **vector store** (this collection uses Supabase/pgvector), and retrieving the closest-matching chunks to hand an LLM as context before it answers.

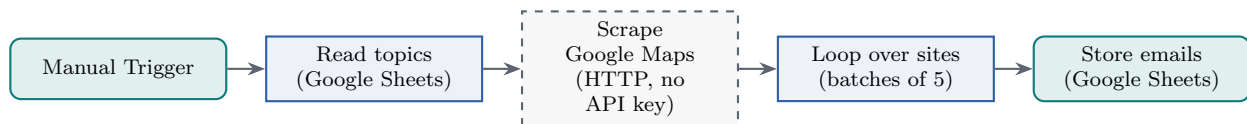
2 The collection at a glance

59 documented automation folders, each with an exported workflow JSON, a README (what it does, why, architecture, setup, honest challenges), a **CREDENTIALS.md**, and a **LICENSE**. Recognizable categories: **lead generation and scraping** (Google Maps and LinkedIn scrapers, cold-outreach icebreaker generators), **AI content pipelines** (social post, SEO post, video, and image generators, the largest being a 190-node social media content engine), **agent/orchestrator systems** (a personal-assistant orchestrator with four callable sub-agents, an Upwork proposal-generator agent, a WhatsApp sales-lead agent), **RAG/vector-store ingestion** (document ingestion into Supabase for agent retrieval), **business operations and CRM** (Stripe invoicing off a CRM webhook, expense tracking, booking utilities), **outreach and email sequencing** (a nine-workflow cold-email system), and **small utility and messaging bots** (Telegram bots, a UUID generator, a screenshot utility).

3 Three worked examples

3.1 Google Maps to Email Scraper

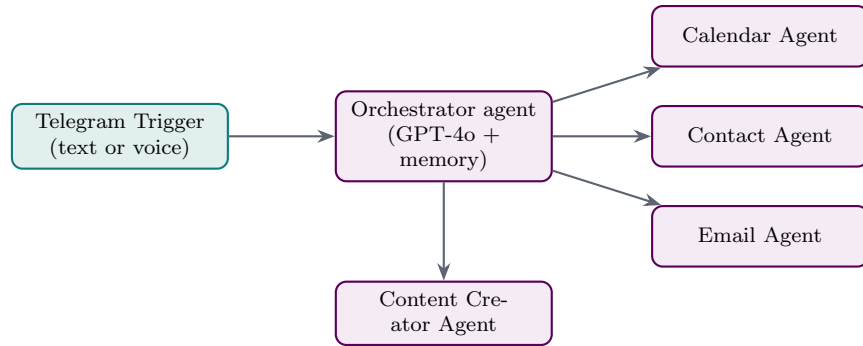
Reads pending search topics from a Google Sheet, scrapes Google Maps by a plain HTTP request (no Maps API key), visits each business website found, extracts emails with a regex, and writes the results back.



Disclosed defects: scraping Google Maps by raw HTML regex has no fallback if the page markup changes; a **Limit1** node with no override caps every manual run to exactly one topic, so a backlog needs one run per topic; deduplication only holds within a single run, so a re-run re-scrapes from scratch; and the README states plainly that scraping Google Maps this way is not something Google’s terms of service condone.

3.2 Ultimate Personal Assistant System

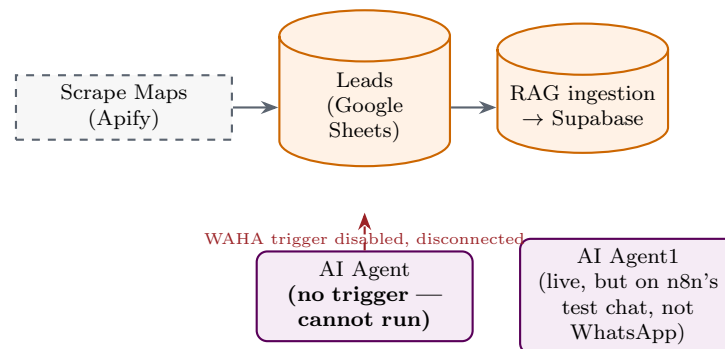
Five workflows around one Telegram bot: an orchestrator agent reads a text or voice message and routes it to exactly one of four specialist sub-agents (calendar, contacts, email, content creation), each its own workflow, called as a tool via n8n’s “Call n8n Workflow Tool” pattern.



Disclosed defects: “get the real ID before you act” rules (e.g. before deleting a calendar event or replying to an email) live only in prompt text, not in any graph-level check, so nothing stops the model from guessing an ID; every sub-agent’s failure collapses into one identical apology string regardless of the real cause; the Content Creator agent runs on a different model provider (Anthropic Claude) than every other agent (GPT-4o) with no explanation given anywhere in the workflow.

3.3 WhatsApp AI Sales Lead System

Despite being named “Cold Calling Automation” in its own exported file (no telephony node exists anywhere in it), this is a Google Maps lead scraper, a Supabase RAG ingestion pipeline, and a WhatsApp-facing AI agent on one canvas.



Disclosed defects: the scraping and Supabase-ingestion halves are fully wired and would run; the WhatsApp-facing agent (**AI Agent**) has prompts and a memory key written explicitly against WhatsApp’s message shape but *no incoming trigger connection at all*, so it cannot execute as exported; the node that actually is connected to a live trigger is a second, parallel agent sitting behind n8n’s own built-in test-chat widget, not WhatsApp; two Cohere reranking nodes sit on the canvas fully configured with zero connections anywhere in the graph.

4 Curation methodology, at a summary level

This is a curation and documentation pass over pre-existing work, not a from-scratch build log. **Survey:** every workflow on the live n8n instance and every on-disk backup file was inventoried in `N8N_WORKFLOW_PROPOSALS.md`, split into **Tier 1** (live agency workflows), **Tier 2** (on-disk files with no live match), and **Tier 3** (downloaded course/community reference material, explicitly excluded as not the agency’s own work). **Approve/reject**, line by line, with near-duplicate test or demo copies grouped into one decision. **Scrub:** personal data and live credentials removed from every exported JSON before it entered this folder. **Document:** a standard README shape (what it

is, why, architecture, setup, honest challenges) for every approved folder. **Verify, honestly:** every README states plainly that it reflects a reading of the exported node graph, not a live execution against real credentials — several go further and flag specific unconfirmed behavior by name rather than asserting it.

A few workflows are named after real clients or their live n8n internal id rather than what they do; where that happened, the folder name and README describe the automation by its function and disclose the naming mismatch honestly, consistent with this Portfolio's attribution rules. Some automations are explicitly flagged as course-derived or community-template-derived (for example, the Cluster SEO Post Generator's own filename carries a Skool-community suffix) rather than presented as original builds.

5 Recurring, honestly-documented defects

The same categories of real problem recur across many automations, not just isolated incidents:

- **Fully-wired nodes with no trigger** — a node can have a model, memory, and tools attached and still never run, because that is a separate connection layer from the one that actually starts it (WhatsApp Sales Lead System).
- **Disabled triggers and inactive workflows shipped as if complete** — a feature can be fully built and simply switched off (RAG Ingestion Pipeline's update handling; Telegram Checklist Generator's only trigger).
- **Dead-end branches with no forward connection** — visible directly in the exported JSON, not inferred (RAG pipeline's Word-document conversion branch).
- **Duplicated logic that can silently drift** — the same business logic rebuilt independently in multiple code nodes or multiple workflow files (WhatsApp system's two ingestion paths; Cold Email system's six copywriting workflows).
- **Hardcoded values standing in for configuration** — spreadsheet IDs, Telegram chat IDs, and ClickUp field indexes typed directly into node parameters instead of centralized.
- **Missing error handling around paid external APIs** — no retry, no fallback branch, sometimes no polling at all, just a fixed wait (Social Media Content Generator, Faceless Shorts System).
- **LLM output trusted without a validation layer** — arithmetic, JSON schemas, and array coercion left to the model with no deterministic check (Expense Tracker, Deep Research Report Generator, Telegram Checklist Generator).

6 What remains blocked, and why

Most originally-blocked automations were later unblocked once the owner enabled per-workflow MCP access in n8n's settings, and got built in later passes (nine automations, including `linkedin-extractor-from` and `gmail-outreach-follow-ups`); several of those disclose real defects found only once the node graph could finally be read.

Five automations remain not built, by the owner's choice, because MCP access was never enabled for them and no backup or on-disk copy exists: a webhook-based Fathom.ai sibling, the main

Submagic video-clip build and its testing copy, the main Heygen video-production build, and a client-named scripting/agent automation. The fix, when it happens, is the same one that already worked for the other nine: enable MCP access on that specific workflow. Two more approved automations were only partially recoverable (a second VAPI call workflow, two Instagram Reel Analyzer variants); each of those folders documents the one variant that could be verified and states plainly what is missing.

Scope of this Brief. This document covers three automations in worked detail out of 59, plus collection-level methodology and defect patterns drawn from 14 READMEs read closely. It does not claim architecture-level review of every folder named in Section 2's category list. See `deep-dive.pdf` for five additional worked examples (RAG Ingestion Pipeline, Social Media Content Generator, CRM Lead to Stripe Invoice, Cold Email Outreach Sequence System, Deep Research Report Generator) with full diagrams.